

Prayers for our World and the Church

19th April 2026

Psalm 28:8

[8] The Lord is the strength of his people; he is the saving refuge of his anointed.

Let us pray...

Thanks to God

Heavenly Father, we thank You for the life of Allan Freer and we thank You that he is now in Your Presence and free of the infirmities of this life.

We pray that You would strengthen and encourage Jan and that we as a congregation would be able to support her at this time and into the foreseeable future.

We thank You that Allan knew Your grace and mercy and trusted in Jesus alone for eternal life.

We face afresh the reality that we are imperfect, prone to temptation and that this life is a preparation for our eternal destiny. We thank You that in Your Presence there is fullness of joy, even as we grieve Allan's passing. May we take comfort in the assurance of Your Word that we will one day see him again, for he has joined that great cloud of witnesses spoken of by the writer to the Hebrews.

The Wide World... and the Wider Church

We thank You for Your Church, the Body of Christ, and for the strength of relationships formed in the bonds of peace, by the work of Your Holy Spirit. We thank You that we can reassure each other of the sure hope in the resurrection, since Jesus has gone before us, and continues to intercede for His people from the throne of Grace in the heavenly realm.

We pray for this world where so many live without that assurance of eternal hope, and we want to see those we know and many we don't to come to know the power of the gospel, and the salvation which Jesus won for them by going to the Cross on their behalf.

We pray for those who despair of being free of their sins, that they would hear the Good News that Jesus has taken the penalty for every sin, has dealt with our guilt and has freed us from the power of the enemy who seeks only to destroy God's people.

Ashburton

We pray for ourselves at Ashburton, as we also continue the work of the Kingdom. We pray for the evening prayer service, that we would become increasingly effective in hearing from You, as well as voicing our concerns. We pray for the individual and small group times of prayer, for the spontaneous private prayers of Your people as they respond to Your prompting, so that in all things we pray according to Your will for Your work among Your people.

We thank You for Your Word, and for Matthew as he preaches today. Grant him the right words to impart to us what You know we need to hear and apply in our lives.

In His Precious Name we pray, Amen.